SpaceX Software Engineering Recruiting Team
RE: Summer 2026 Software Engineer Internship/ Co-op

Dear SpaceX Software Engineering Recruiting Team,

I am a sophomore computer science student at the University of Missouri-Kansas City with a 3.9 GPA. I am thrilled to apply for the software engineering internship because it represents an incredible opportunity to learn from a company whose work I deeply admire. I wholeheartedly agree with SpaceX's core belief that a future where humanity is out exploring the stars is fundamentally more exciting and meaningful than one where we are not. Contributing to that future with SpaceX would be a milestone in my life and career that I would take great pride in.

Here's how my coursework and prior experience align with the preferred skills and experience for the internship:

Programming proficiency: I am proficient in Python and will be skilled in C++ by the start of the internship through coursework at UMKC. I have completed course-related projects, including an object-oriented Movie Theatre Booking System, a Video Game Transaction Analyzer, and a Workout Builder & Tracker. Each of these projects gave me experience in enumerating software requirements, debugging, and unit testing.

Strong foundations in performance optimization: In the upcoming Spring 2026 semester, my courses will cover memory management, pointer logic, algorithmic efficiency, stacks, queues, and basic networking concepts. The coursework will give me hands-on experience optimizing code for performance and understanding computer architecture.

Effective communication and ability to work in dynamic, cross-functional settings: Before I became a student, I served as an organizer and master of ceremonies for the Kansas City chapter of 1 Million Cups, a national startup community created by the Ewing Marion Kauffman Foundation. I also ran a freelance web development consultancy and managed client relationships and crews for my window cleaning business. These experiences demonstrate my comfort level working independently and collaboratively, my ability to take initiative, and my strong interpersonal and communication skills.

My most important and valuable skills are a deep desire to learn and the ability to learn quickly, a profound work ethic, and a passion for working with others to accomplish incredible things. I believe these skills would be a good fit for SpaceX's culture. It would be an honor to participate in the Summer 2026 internship and contribute to the mission-critical software that will take humanity to the stars. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully,
Tyler Prince
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